

GLOBAL CLIENTELE

Chanakya's client list includes some of the biggest names in luxury. Apart from Dior, there's Fendi, Prada, Valentino, Celine, and Saint Laurent



and Madhvi Parekh called 'Mul Mathi: From The Roots', in collaboration with Chanakya was put on display.

Then it works with international *maisons* and offers them a collection of crafts. There is the foundation and the school, which is the education vertical. Swali says they are planning to tie up with universities abroad and offer a course in craft.

As a policy, Chanakya doesn't take on many clients. "We work with a few, but they're very close partnerships, where we almost exclusively design their craft requirements," says Swali. It works both ways. Sometimes brands give them a mood board and they work accordingly, or present a new capsule of research techniques that then become part of the collection.

She says the good thing about international collaborations is that Chanakya works way in advance. Typically, she works three seasons in advance—currently, she is working on Autumn/Winter 24/25. "So it gives us enough time to present a new collection and to begin working on prototypes." Since retail is very organised internationally, brands collate orders and send them to Chanakya. "So the whole process is very sustainable as it is all made to order," explains Swali.

She says one of the biggest changes globally over the past few decades is that there is more awareness now. "Earlier, it was normal to celebrate something like fur. But now there is a deepened sense of consciousness, where luxury is becoming much more purpose-led. And, thankfully, customers are more aware of the repercussions of their choices."

As Swali continues to work with global luxury brands, she is extremely conscious of quality. "Our quality tolerances are one millimetre, the highest standard of craft. All our affiliates are certified globally for quality management systems. We are not only up to global standards, but we are also setting standards globally," she says. Considering its illustrious client list, others, too, seem very aware of that quality. **BT**

@smitabw